

UsrHelper — User Guide

Extension version: 0.4.1+ · [Wersja polska](#)

UsrHelper is a Chrome extension that makes reporting issues during software deployments effortless. Take an annotated screenshot or record a screencast with voice narration — the finished report is saved on your disk and handed to email in one click. Everything stays on your machine; the extension sends no data to any server.

Table of contents

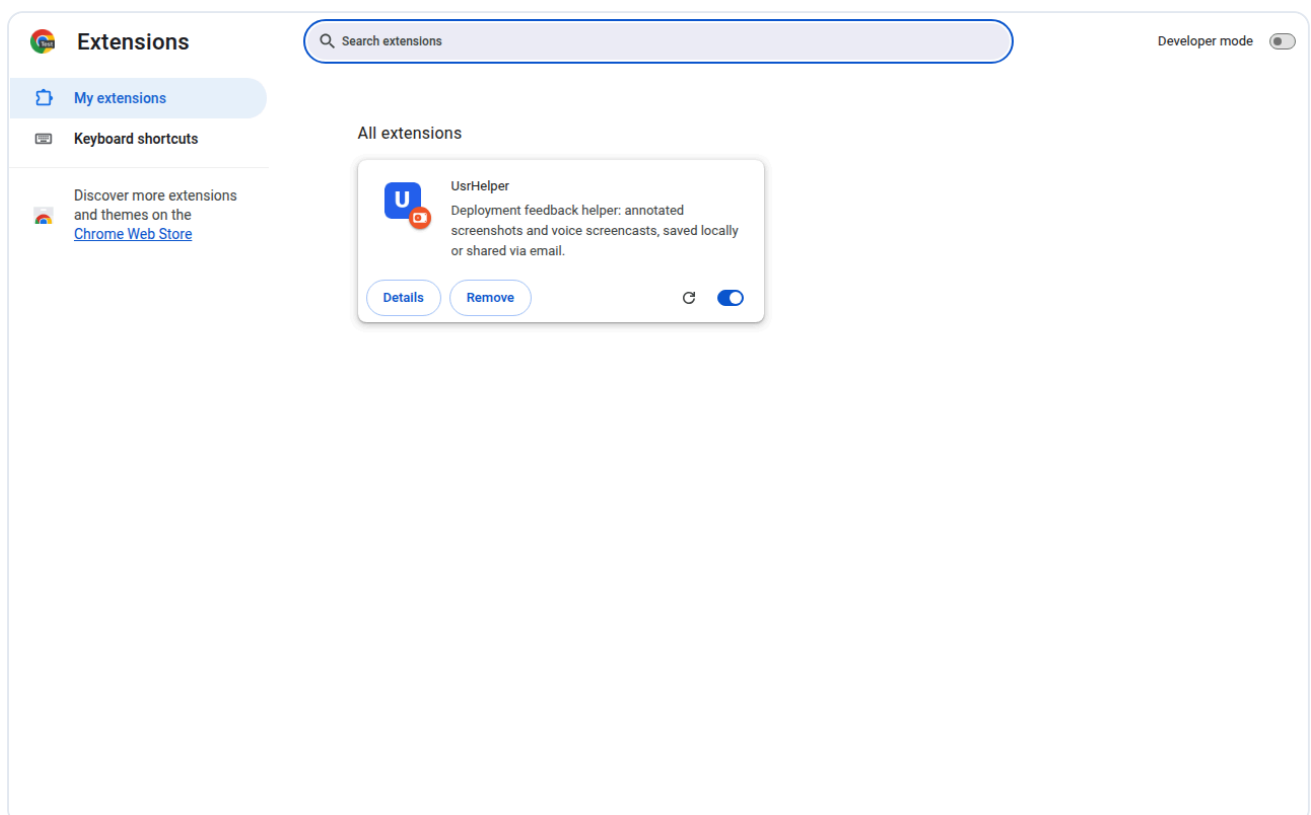
1. [Installation](#)
 2. [First-time setup](#)
 3. [Screenshots](#)
 4. [Annotation editor](#)
 5. [Recording screencasts](#)
 6. [History and project profiles](#)
 7. [What a report contains](#)
 8. [Troubleshooting \(FAQ\)](#)
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1. Installation

The easy way — [install from the Chrome Web Store](#). One click, automatic updates, nothing else to do. Then skip to [First-time setup](#).

The rest of this section covers the manual install, which you only need if your organisation blocks the Web Store or you want to run a specific build.

1. Download the latest `usrhelper-X.Y.Z-chrome.zip` from [GitHub Releases](#).
2. Unpack the archive into a permanent folder (e.g. `C:\UsrHelper` or `~/UsrHelper`). **The folder must stay on disk** — Chrome loads the extension from there.
3. Open `chrome://extensions` and enable **Developer mode** (toggle in the top-right corner).
4. Click **Load unpacked** and select the unpacked folder (the one containing `manifest.json`).
5. Pin the **U** icon to the toolbar: puzzle-piece icon → pin next to "UsrHelper".



Updating: download the new zip, replace the folder contents, and click  (Reload) next to the extension on `chrome://extensions`.

2. First-time setup

Open the settings: click the **U** icon → **Settings** (or `chrome://extensions` → **UsrHelper** → **Details** → **Extension options**).

UsrHelper Settings

Language
English

REPORTER DETAILS

Customer no. C-102 Company ACME Ltd

First name Jan Last name Kowalski AnyDesk no. 123 456 789

Included in every report file and email so the developer knows who to contact.

PROJECT PROFILES

Profile name Default Active Export Delete profile

Email to (comma-separated) dev@yourcompany.com

CC (comma-separated) pm@yourcompany.com

Project domains (console error capture) app.example.com, *.staging.example.com, localhost

Comma-separated, e.g. app.example.com, *.staging.example.com, localhost. Leave empty and console errors are not captured anywhere — the extension then stays out of every page's call stack, so no site can see it. Uncaught errors and rejected promises are always captured, on every page.

Email subject prefix [UsrHelper] Subfolder in Downloads UsrHelper/my-project

Configure top to bottom:

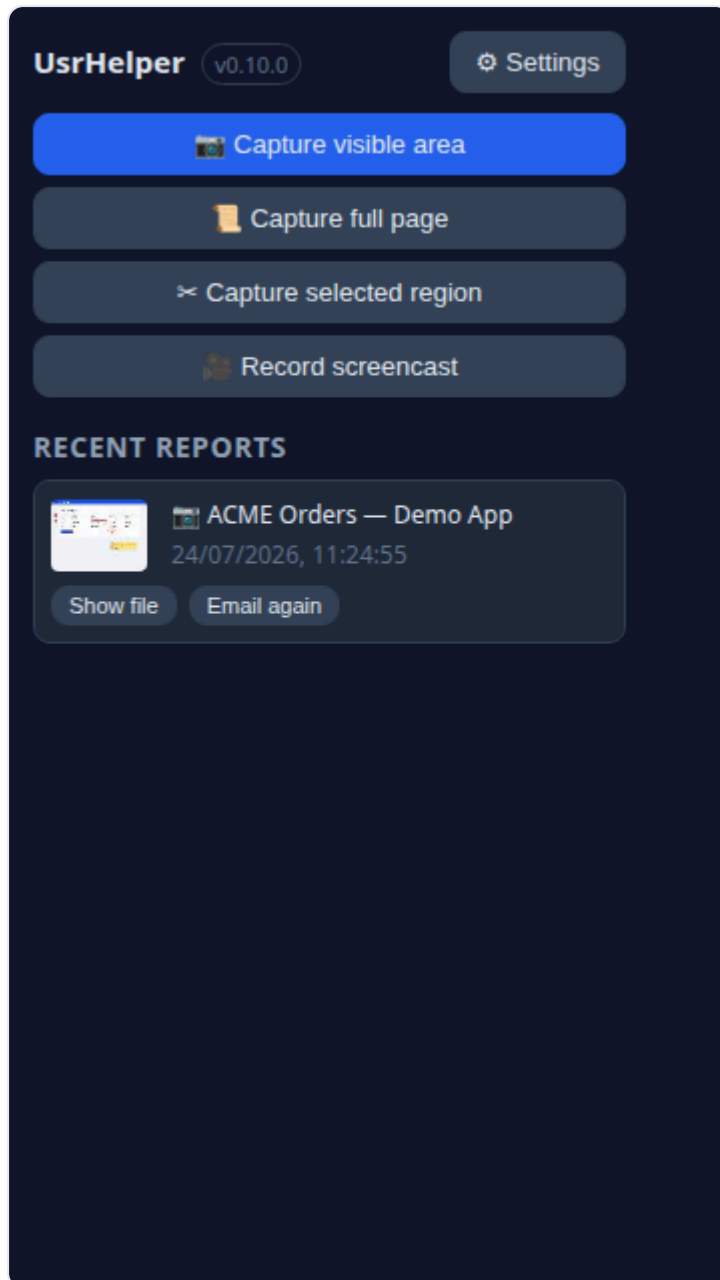
Section	What to enter
Language	English (default) or Polski.
Reporter details	Customer no., company, first and last name, AnyDesk number — included in every report and email so the developer knows who is reporting and how to connect.
Project profiles	Recipient addresses (Email to) and carbon copy (CC), comma-separated; email subject prefix (e.g. <code>[Project X]</code>); the subfolder in Downloads where files land; an optional description template; and recording limits (clip length / maximum total).

Section	What to enter
Toggles	Click/keystroke visualization on recordings, timestamp overlay, camera bubble, click-path tracking, console error capture.

Every change saves automatically (green "Settings saved" toast).

3. Screenshots

Click the **U** icon in the toolbar:



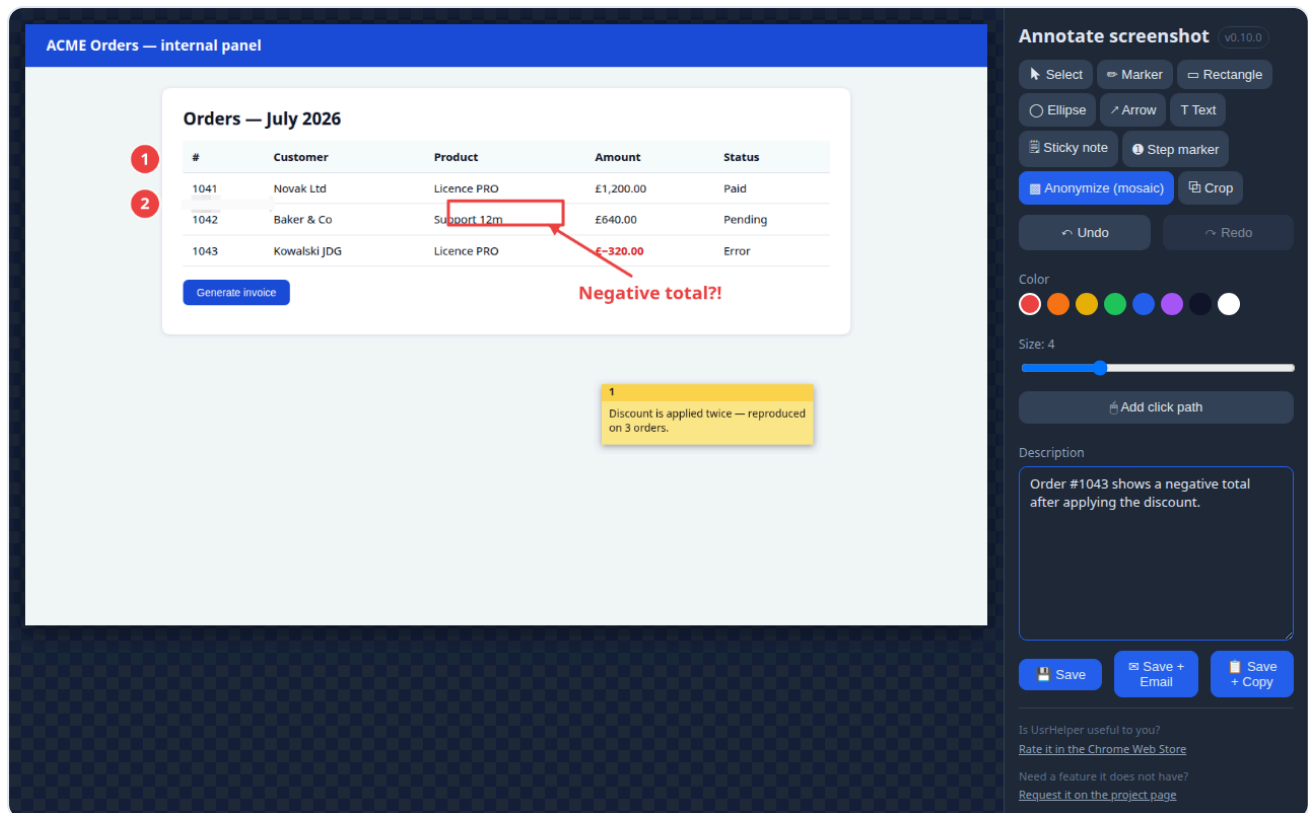
Three capture modes are available:

- **📷 Capture visible area** — instant capture of what you see in the window.
- **📄 Capture full page** — the extension scrolls the page top to bottom and stitches one tall image (sticky headers appear only once).
- **✂ Capture selected region** — the cursor becomes a crosshair; drag a rectangle over the page. `Esc` cancels.

Each capture opens the **annotation editor** in a new tab.

Note: browser-internal pages (`chrome://...` , Chrome Web Store) cannot be captured — the buttons will be greyed out there.

4. Annotation editor



Tools (right-hand panel):

Tool	What it does
Select	Click an annotation to select; drag to move; <code>Delete</code> removes it.
Marker	Freehand drawing.
Rectangle / Ellipse	Frame the relevant element.
Arrow	Point at the problem.
Text	Click on the image, type, confirm with <code>Enter</code> (<code>Esc</code> cancels).
Sticky note	A yellow note for a comment of a sentence or two. <code>Enter</code> breaks the line, <code>Ctrl+Enter</code> adds the note (<code>Esc</code> cancels). Notes are numbered on the image, and their number and text also go into the <code>.json</code> and the email, so the developer can quote them instead of retyping from the screenshot.

Tool	What it does
Step marker	Each click drops a numbered circle (1, 2, 3...) — perfect for step-by-step instructions.
Anonymize (mosaic)	Paint over sensitive data (names, amounts, tokens) — the area is irreversibly turned into a pixel mosaic in the saved file.
Crop	Drag a rectangle and click "Apply crop".

Plus: **color** and **size** pickers, full **Undo / Redo** (`Ctrl+Z` / `Ctrl+Y`), and the **"Add click path"** button — it stamps orange numbered markers where you clicked on the page before capturing.

Describe the issue in the **Description** field, then:

-  **Save** — a PNG plus a `.json` metadata file land in `Downloads/<subfolder>/` with a timestamp in the name (e.g. `UsrHelper_2026-07-17_14-32-05.png`);
-  **Save + Email** — additionally opens a new message in your mail client with recipients, subject, and description pre-filled. **You attach the file manually** — the extension shows the exact path of the saved file.
-  **Save + Copy** — additionally copies the whole report to the clipboard as **Markdown**: a heading, a table with the page address, the exact time, your machine and browser, then the sticky notes, the recent console errors and the names of the saved files. Paste it straight into a Jira ticket, a GitHub or GitLab issue, or a Teams message instead of retyping it. **The image itself is not copied** — the text names the file so you can attach or drag it in.

Orders — July 2026

#	Customer	Product	Amount	Status
1041	Novak Ltd	Licence PRO	£1,200.00	Paid
1042	Baker & Co	Support 12m	£640.00	Pending
1043	Kowalski JDG	Licence PRO	£-320.00	Error

[Generate invoice](#)

Negative total?!

1

Discount is applied twice — reproduced on 3 orders.

Annotate screenshot v0.10.0

Select Marker Rectangle
Ellipse Arrow T Text
Sticky note Step marker

Anonymize (mosaic) Crop

Undo Redo

Color



Size: 4



Add click path

Description

Order #1043 shows a negative total after applying the discount.

Save

Save + Email

Save + Copy

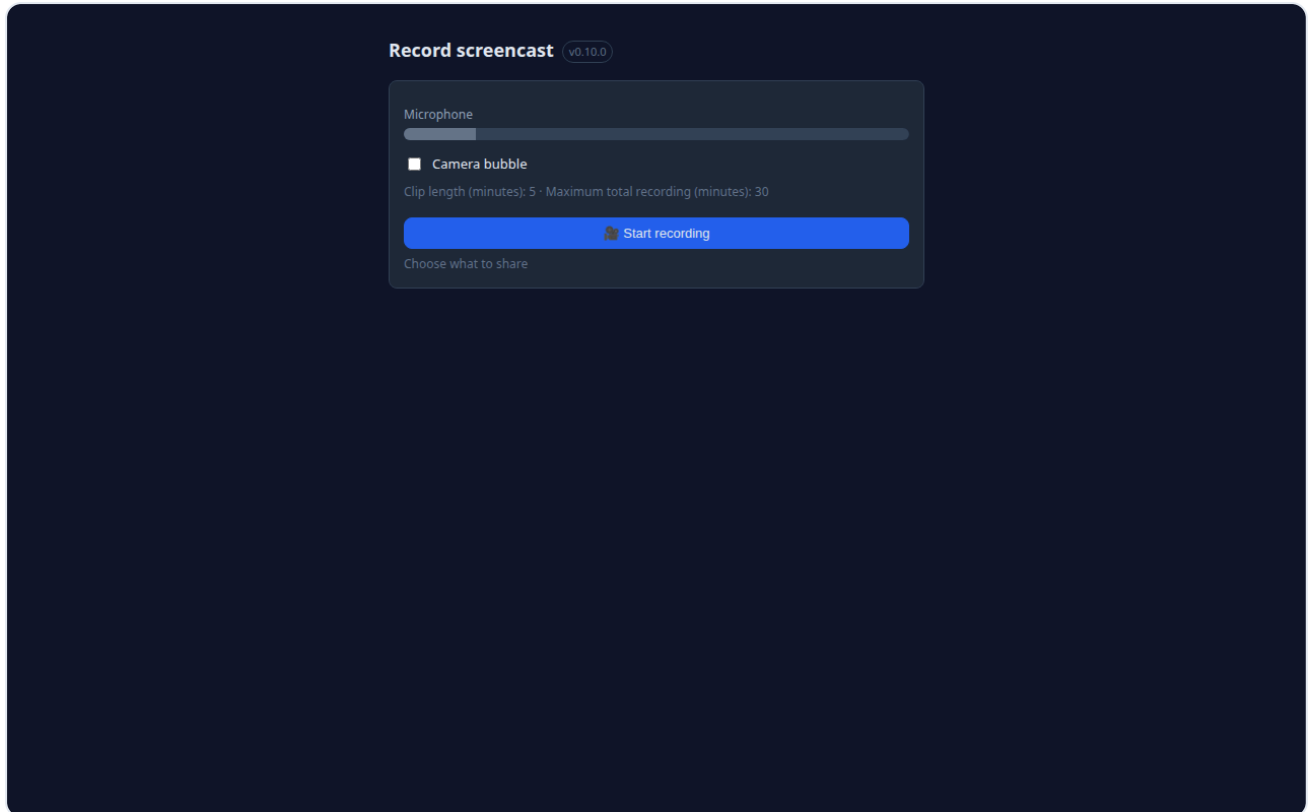
Saved to

Downloads/UsrHelper/my-project/UsrHelper_2026-07-24_11-24-55.png

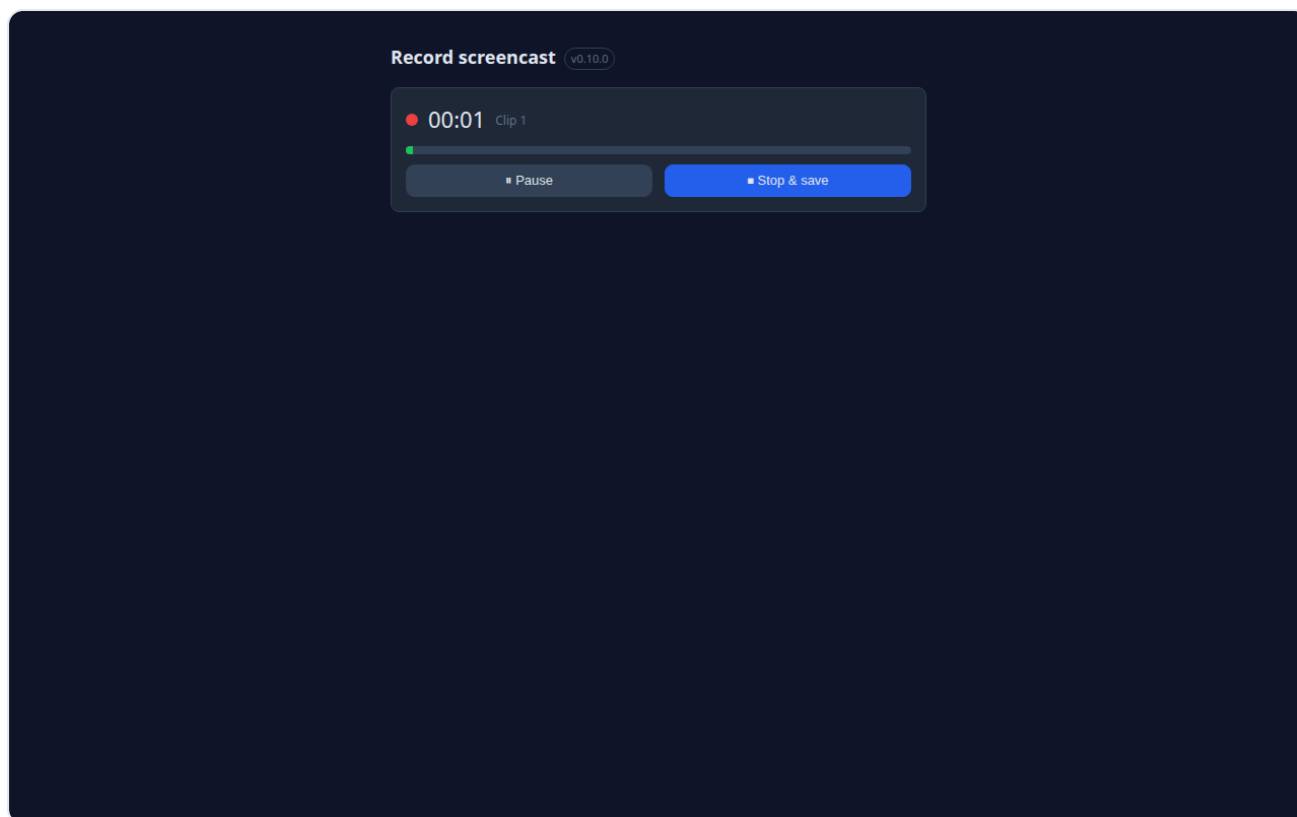
Attach the saved file to the email:
UsrHelper/my-project/UsrHelper_2026-07-24_11-24-55.png

5. Recording screencasts

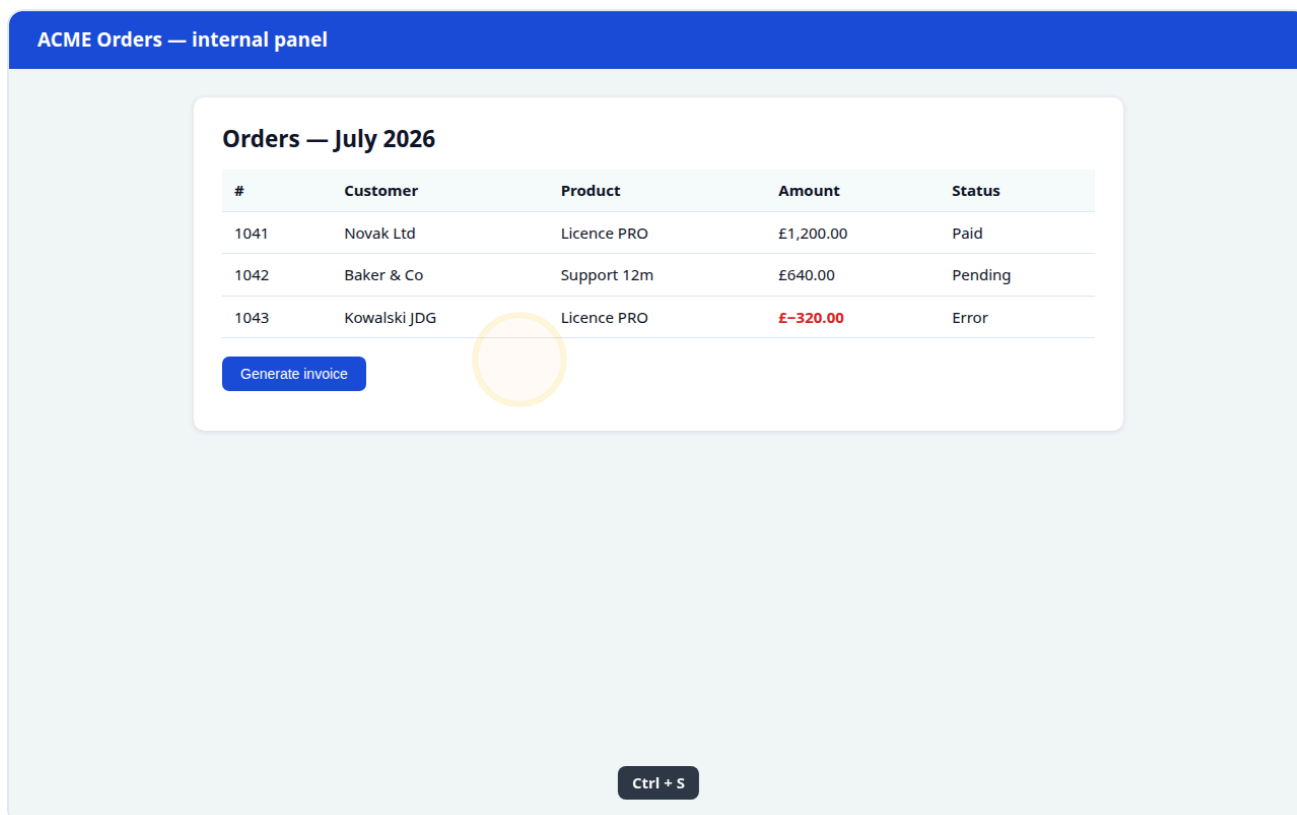
Click  **Record screencast** in the popup. The recording panel opens:



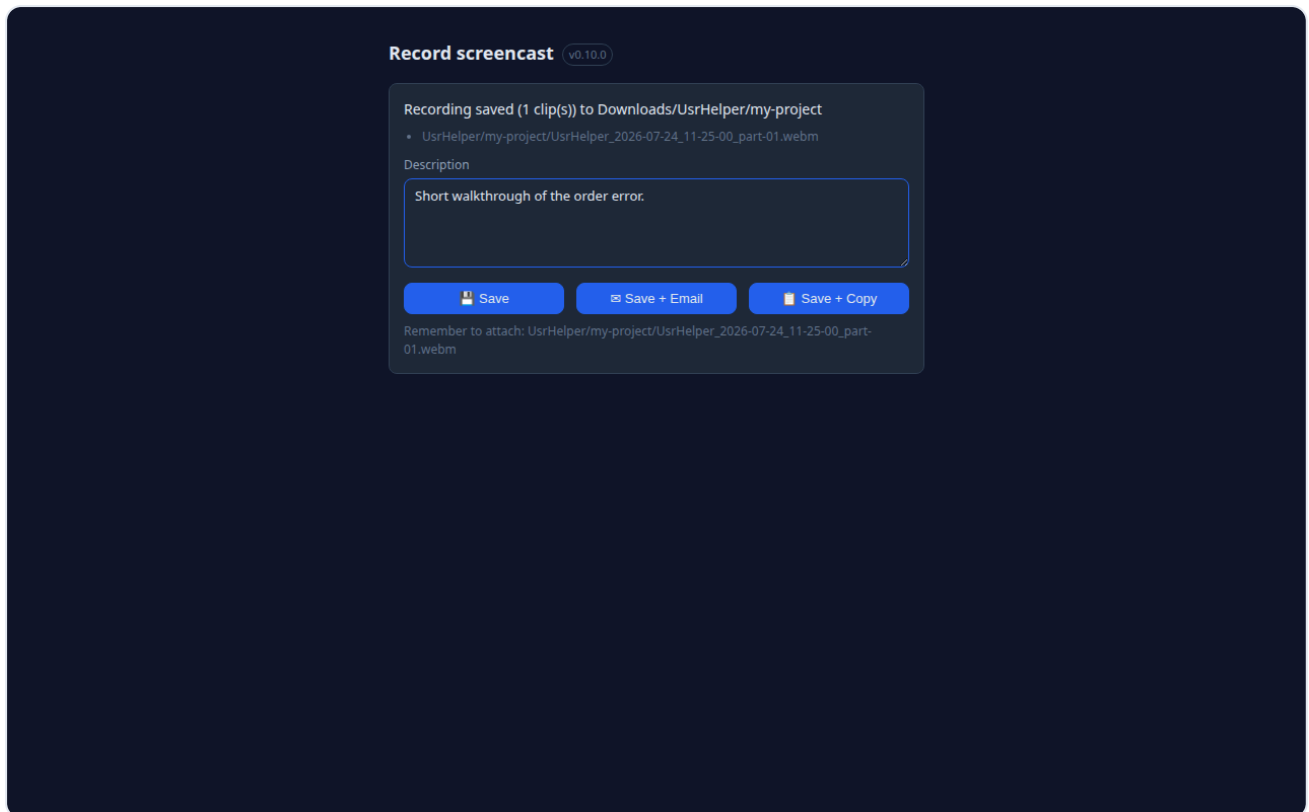
1. **Check the microphone** — the green bar moves when you speak. No movement = no audio on the recording.
2. Optionally enable the **camera bubble** (your face in a circle, Loom-style).
3. Click **Start recording** and pick what to share in Chrome's dialog: **tab / window / entire screen**.
4. After the **3-2-1** countdown the recording starts — switch freely between tabs and applications.



While recording, pages show: **yellow ripples** on clicks (blue for right-click), **key captions** (e.g. `Ctrl + S` — plain typing is never shown, for privacy), and a **clock** in the corner:



Pause / Resume stops the clock and the recording. ■ **Stop & save** ends the session. The recording splits automatically into **standalone clips** (default: 5 minutes each, 30-minute total cap — configurable per profile). Each clip is a separate `.webm` file (`..._part-01.webm` , `..._part-02.webm`).



After stopping, add a description and click  **Save** (writes the `.json` metadata),  **Save + Email**, or  **Save + Copy** to put the report in the clipboard as Markdown.

6. History and project profiles

The popup lists your **recent reports** with thumbnails:

- **Show file** — opens the file manager with the file selected;
- **Email again** — opens a new email message with the report details.

If you have several **project profiles** (different recipients, folders, limits), switch them in the popup with a single dropdown — all subsequent reports use the active profile.

Getting a ready-made profile from your developer. In Settings, **Export** saves the active profile as a JSON file you can send to your testers; **Import profile...** reads such a file. The import first shows what the file would add — the recipient addresses above all, since that is where finished reports will go — and stores nothing until you confirm. The file carries project settings only: never your name, customer number or AnyDesk number, and never your report history.

7. What a report contains

Every report is a set of files in `Downloads/<subfolder>/` :

File	Contents
<code>UsrHelper_<date>_<time>.png</code>	The annotated screenshot with a timestamp in the corner.
<code>UsrHelper_<date>_<time>_part-NN.webm</code>	Recording clips (with the burned-in clock and camera bubble).
<code>UsrHelper_<date>_<time>.json</code>	Description, reporter details, exact time, page URL and title, environment (browser, OS, CPU architecture, resolution), recent JavaScript errors, sticky notes with their numbers, click path, file list.

The timestamp lives in three places: the file name, visibly on the image/recording, and in the `.json` — easy to correlate with server logs.

8. Troubleshooting (FAQ)

The capture buttons are greyed out. You are on a browser-internal page (`chrome://...`) or the Chrome Web Store — these cannot be captured. Switch to a regular page.

The recording has no audio. Chrome blocked the microphone for the extension. Click the lock/permissions icon in the recorder tab's address bar and allow the microphone, or check your system microphone. The panel warns before starting when no mic is available.

The recording stopped by itself. You hit the maximum length (default 30 min). All clips up to that point are saved. Change the limit in the profile settings.

Where are my files? In `Downloads/<subfolder>/` (set the subfolder in the profile; default `UsrHelper`). Fastest route: popup → **Show file**.

The email opens without the attachment. That is a `mailto:` limitation — no mail client lets an extension attach files automatically. The extension shows the exact path; drag the file into the message.

I pasted the copied report and the screenshot is missing. Only the text is copied. The Markdown names the saved file — attach or drag it into the ticket, and the tracker will upload it.

The pasted report shows raw `<table>` characters instead of a table. The target does not render Markdown (some chat boxes and plain-text fields do not). The report is still complete and readable; a Jira, GitHub or GitLab description field renders it properly.

Nothing was copied. Chrome refuses a clipboard write when the tab lost focus. The extension then shows the report in a text box with everything selected — press `Ctrl+C` (`Cmd+C`) to copy it by hand. Your files are already saved either way.

Is the mosaic really safe? Yes. The mosaic is baked into the PNG's pixel data at save time — the original pixels cannot be recovered from the exported file.

